Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Ear-led improvisation, anticipatory guide tones, motif prediction, and spontaneous role switching

SECTION X | EAR LEADS THE HAND

Level 77 connected relative hearing to immediate fretboard action. Level 78 removes the final separation between ear training and improvisation: the player hears or sings the destination before the hand moves, predicts how a motif should continue, and changes between accompaniment and lead roles without losing the form.

1. Pre-hear

The next structural note exists in the ear before it exists on the fretboard.

2. Predict

A motif is continued from its rhythm, contour, chord role, and harmonic direction.

3. Switch roles

Comping and lead are two views of the same form; the player can hand off between them on cue.

Improvisation control loop

```
HEAR      next chord / target / contour
SING      destination or first phrase tone
LOCATE    silent fretboard target
PLAY      target before filler
LISTEN    compare result to prediction
ANSWER    develop or contrast motif
RETURN    resume accompaniment / form
```

Written workload

Module	Events
A - pre-heard targets	96
B - guide tones	96
C - prediction	96
D - motifs	96
E - comp -> lead	128
F - lead -> comp	128
G - density roles	128
H - capstone	128
TOTAL	896

Priority rule

If a pre-heard target is lost, simplify the phrase to one chord tone and one rest. Do not replace prediction with fretboard searching or fill the bar with scale motion. The target and form have priority over note count.

VOICE FIRST: when a cell says SING, the voice occurs before the guitar attack. Humming is acceptable; exact vocal tone quality is irrelevant.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module A - pre-heard target matrix: major ii-V-I

12 TARGETS | 48 EVENTS

SING THE NEXT BEAT-ONE TARGET DURING BEAT 4 OF THE CURRENT BAR

Bar	Chord	Target role	Target pitch	Sing during	Play
1	Dm7	b3	F	count-in 4	
2	G7	3	B	bar 1 beat 4	
3	Cmaj7	3	E	bar 2 beat 4	
4	Cmaj7	7	B	bar 3 beat 4	
5	Dm7	b7	C	bar 4 beat 4	
6	G7	b7	F	bar 5 beat 4	
7	Cmaj7	5	G	bar 6 beat 4	
8	Cmaj7	R	C	bar 7 beat 4	
9	Dm7	R	D	bar 8 beat 4	
10	G7	5	D	bar 9 beat 4	
11	Cmaj7	7	B	bar 10 beat 4	
12	Cmaj7	R	C	bar 11 beat 4	

Play one quarter-note target on beat 1, then leave beats 2-4 empty on the first pass. On later passes, add at most two notes after the target while keeping beat 4 clear for the sung preview.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module A - pre-heard target matrix: minor iiø-V-i

12 TARGETS | 48 EVENTS

THE DOMINANT THIRD G# MUST BE HEARD BEFORE THE E7 BAR ARRIVES

Bar	Chord	Target role	Target pitch	Sing during	Resolution
1	Bm7b5	b3	D	count-in 4	hold
2	E7	3	G#	bar 1 beat 4	-> A later
3	Am7	b3	C	bar 2 beat 4	settle
4	Am7	b7	G	bar 3 beat 4	hold
5	Bm7b5	b5	F	bar 4 beat 4	-> E/D
6	E7	b7	D	bar 5 beat 4	-> C
7	Am7	5	E	bar 6 beat 4	settle
8	Am7	R	A	bar 7 beat 4	settle
9	Bm7b5	R	B	bar 8 beat 4	hold
10	E7	3	G#	bar 9 beat 4	-> A
11	Am7	b3	C	bar 10 beat 4	settle
12	Am7	R	A	bar 11 beat 4	close

Second pass: sing the target silently in the mind instead of aloud, then play it. If accuracy drops, return immediately to audible singing.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module B - anticipatory guide-tone lines: major cadence

6 ROUTES | 48 EVENTS

SING THE GUIDE TONE BEFORE THE CHORD CHANGE; LET THE CHORD CONFIRM WHAT THE EAR EXPECTED

C major: Dm7 -> G7 -> Cmaj7	V1 F -> F -> E V2 C -> B -> B	Sing -> play -> combine
G major: Am7 -> D7 -> Gmaj7	V1 C -> C -> B V2 G -> F# -> F#	Sing -> play -> combine
D major: Em7 -> A7 -> Dmaj7	V1 G -> G -> F# V2 D -> C# -> C#	Sing -> play -> combine
A major: Bm7 -> E7 -> Amaj7	V1 D -> D -> C# V2 A -> G# -> G#	Sing -> play -> combine
E major: F#m7 -> B7 -> Emaj7	V1 A -> A -> G# V2 E -> D# -> D#	Sing -> play -> combine
F major: Gm7 -> C7 -> Fmaj7	V1 Bb -> Bb -> A V2 F -> E -> E	Sing -> play -> combine

Passes: voice 1 only; voice 2 only; both as dyad; dyad while lightly comping roots; free phrase that lands on the sung guide tone.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module B - anticipatory guide-tone lines: minor cadence

6 ROUTES | 48 EVENTS

HEAR THE RAISED DOMINANT THIRD BEFORE IT RESOLVES INTO THE MINOR TONIC

A minor: Bm7b5 -> E7 -> Am7	V1 D -> D -> C V2 A -> G# -> G	Sing -> play -> resolve
E minor: F#m7b5 -> B7 -> Em7	V1 A -> A -> G V2 E -> D# -> D	Sing -> play -> resolve
B minor: C#m7b5 -> F#7 -> Bm7	V1 E -> E -> D V2 B -> A# -> A	Sing -> play -> resolve
F# minor: G#m7b5 -> C#7 -> F#m7	V1 B -> B -> A V2 F# -> E# -> E	Sing -> play -> resolve
C# minor: D#m7b5 -> G#7 -> C#m7	V1 F# -> F# -> E V2 C# -> B# -> B	Sing -> play -> resolve
D minor: Em7b5 -> A7 -> Dm7	V1 G -> G -> F V2 D -> C# -> C	Sing -> play -> resolve

Do not flatten the dominant third because the destination is minor. The leading tone belongs to the dominant function and then resolves.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module C - sung phrase prediction: complete the final two notes

12 PHRASES | 48 EVENTS

HEAR THE CONTINUATION BEFORE REVEALING OR PLAYING THE ANSWER

Card	Context	Heard opening	Predict / sing	Degree answer
1	C major	C-D-E-G	E-D	3-2
2	C major	G-A-G-E	D-C	2-1
3	G major	G-B-A-D	C-B	4-3
4	D major	A-F#-E-D	C#-D	7-1
5	A minor	A-C-D-E	G-E	b7-5
6	E minor	B-A-G-F#	E-G	1-b3
7	A harmonic minor	E-F-G#-A	G#-E	7-5
8	A melodic minor	A-B-C-E	F#-G#	6-7
9	Cmaj7	E-G-B	C-B	R-7
10	G7	B-D-F	E-D	13-5
11	E7	G#-B-D	C-B	b13-5
12	AmMaj7	C-E-G#	A-G#	R-7

Partner plays only the opening. Player sings two continuation notes, then compares with the printed answer. Variations are allowed only after the printed continuation can be predicted reliably.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module C - predict the next chord-tone target from function

12 HARMONIC PROMPTS | 48 EVENTS

THE CHORD SYMBOL IS HIDDEN UNTIL AFTER THE TARGET IS SUNG

Card	Key	Function move	Requested target	Correct pitch
1	C major	ii -> V	3 of V	B
2	C major	V -> I	3 of I	E
3	C major	IV -> V	b7 of V	F
4	G major	ii -> V	3 of V	F#
5	D major	V -> I	7 of I	C#
6	A major	ii -> V	3 of V	G#
7	A minor	iiø -> V	3 of V	G#
8	A minor	V -> i	b3 of i	C
9	E minor	iiø -> V	3 of V	D#
10	D minor	V -> i	b3 of i	F
11	A melodic minor	IV7 -> V7	3 of V7	G#
12	C# minor	V7alt -> i	b3 of i	E

Player hears or reads only the key and function move, sings the requested chord tone, then plays it in two registers. Reveal the chord name only for verification.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module D - motif continuation: keep rhythm, predict contour

8 CELLS | 64 EVENTS

A MOTIF IS NOT JUST A PITCH ORDER. KEEP ONE IDENTITY VARIABLE FIXED WHILE ANOTHER CHANGES.

1. Cmaj7

```
Q: C-E-G-E
A: E-G-B-G
```

same rhythm, higher answer

2. Dm7

```
Q: D-F-A-F
A: C-A-F-D
```

same rhythm, lower answer

3. G7

```
Q: G-B-D-F
A: F-D-B-G
```

reverse contour

4. Am7

```
Q: A-C-E-G
A: C-E-G-E
```

compress range

5. Cmaj7

```
Q: E-G-B-C
A: E-G-B-C
```

shift up octave

6. E7

```
Q: E-G#-B-D
A: A-C-E-G
```

same contour into Am

7. Dm7 -> G7

```
Q: F-A-C-A
A: B-D-F-D
```

answer on V

8. Bm7b5 -> E7

```
Q: D-F-A-F
A: G#-B-D-B
```

answer on V

First sing the answer. Then play question and answer continuously. Final pass: invent a new answer obeying the same stated rule.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module D - motif prediction across chord changes

8 CELLS | 32 TARGETS

KEEP THE MOTIF RHYTHM; CHANGE ONLY THE NOTES REQUIRED BY THE NEW CHORD

Move	Question	Predicted answer	Target logic
Dm7 -> G7	F-A-C-A	B-D-F-D	beat 1 = chord 3rd
G7 -> Cmaj7	B-D-F-D	E-G-B-G	beat 1 = chord 3rd
Am7 -> D7	C-E-G-E	F#-A-C-A	beat 1 = chord 3rd
D7 -> Gmaj7	F#-A-C-A	B-D-F#-D	beat 1 = chord 3rd
Bm7b5 -> E7	D-F-A-F	G#-B-D-B	beat 1 = chord 3rd
E7 -> Am7	G#-B-D-B	C-E-G-E	beat 1 = chord 3rd
F#m7b5 -> B7	A-C-E-C	D#-F#-A-F#	beat 1 = chord 3rd
B7 -> Em7	D#-F#-A-F#	G-B-D-B	beat 1 = chord 3rd

Third pass: preserve the question rhythm but choose a different chord tone on beat 1. The chord change must remain audible before any scale filler is added.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module E - accompaniment to lead: four-bar handoff cells

8 CELLS | 64 EVENTS

COMP FOR TWO BARS, SING THE LEAD ENTRANCE, THEN ANSWER FOR TWO BARS

1. C major

Cmaj7 | Am7 | Dm7 | G7

Sing lead entry: E | triad shells -> lead

2. G major

Gmaj7 | Em7 | Am7 | D7

Sing lead entry: B | shells -> arpeggio

3. D major

Dmaj7 | Bm7 | Em7 | A7

Sing lead entry: F# | triads -> motif

4. A major

Amaj7 | F#m7 | Bm7 | E7

Sing lead entry: C# | shells -> guide line

5. A minor

Am7 | Dm7 | Bm7b5 | E7

Sing lead entry: C | shells -> minor phrase

6. E minor

Em7 | Am7 | F#m7b5 | B7

Sing lead entry: G | shells -> minor phrase

7. A melodic minor

AmMaj7 | D7 | Bm7 | E7

Sing lead entry: G# | upper triad -> mode color

8. C# minor

C#m7 | F#m7 | G#7alt | C#m7

Sing lead entry: E | shells -> altered answer

Bars 1-2 stay accompaniment. The lead target is sung during bar 2 beat 4. Bars 3-4 are lead. Do not stop strumming early to prepare the solo.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module E - accompaniment-to-lead register orchestration

4 ROUTES | 64 EVENTS

THE ROLE CHANGE SHOULD ALSO CHANGE REGISTER, DENSITY, OR ATTACK ZONE

Low comp -> high lead

Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	Comp: roots/shells	Lead: G-B-e triad fragments

Middle comp -> low lead

Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	Comp: D-G-B shells	Lead: low E/A arpeggio targets

High comp -> middle lead

Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-Cmaj7	Comp: G-B-e triads	Lead: D-G-B guide-tone line

Partial chords -> single-note lead

Bm7b5-E7-Am7-Am7	Comp: 3-string shells	Lead: diagonal chord-tone phrase

At the handoff, change one arrangement variable intentionally. A role change that sounds identical in register, density, and articulation is difficult for an ensemble listener to perceive.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module F - lead to accompaniment: cadence-and-return cells

8 CELLS | 64 EVENTS

THE SOLO MUST END EARLY ENOUGH FOR THE COMPING ROLE TO RE-ENTER ON TIME

Key	Lead cadence -> comp	Last lead attack	Resolution
C major	lead ends on B -> comp Cmaj7	bar 4 beat 3	B -> C
G major	lead ends on F# -> comp Gmaj7	bar 4 beat 3	F# -> G
A minor	lead ends on G# -> comp Am	bar 4 beat 3	G# -> A
E minor	lead ends on D# -> comp Em	bar 4 beat 3	D# -> E
D major	lead ends on C# -> comp Dmaj7	bar 4 & of 2	C# -> D
A major	lead ends on G# -> comp Amaj7	bar 4 & of 2	G# -> A
A melodic minor	lead G# -> comp Am6	bar 4 beat 3	G# -> A / F# color
C# minor	lead B# -> comp C#m	bar 4 beat 3	B# -> C#

After the final lead attack, physically re-form the accompaniment voicing during the remaining silence. The chord re-entry must land on the announced subdivision without an extra setup strum.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module F - lead-to-comp cue recovery

8 CUE CARDS | 64 EVENTS

WHEN A ROLE-SWITCH CUE ARRIVES EARLY, SIMPLIFY THE LEAD INSTEAD OF MISSING THE HANDOFF

Cue at beat 1

finish current target; comp next bar

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Visual nod

acknowledge while maintaining pulse

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Cue at beat 2

one answer note; leave beat 4 free

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Drum fill

hear final fill beat; enter after it

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Cue at beat 3

resolve immediately; re-form chord

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Held ensemble chord

reduce to guide tone; wait for release

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Cue at beat 4

no new lead note; comp next beat 1

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Unexpected extra bar

repeat motif or comp shell; do not invent new form

Practice with partner calling cue randomly.

Recovery priority: pulse -> bar number -> role -> harmony -> texture -> embellishment.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module G - sparse versus dense role-switch studies

8 STUDIES | 64 EVENTS

DENSITY CHANGES MUST NOT CHANGE THE TARGET SCHEDULE OR THE FORM

Progression	Role A	Density	Role B	Density
Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	Sparse comp	1 shell / bar	Dense lead	5 tones / bar
Am-Dm-E7-Am	Sparse lead	2 tones / bar	Dense comp	8th-note stabs
Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-Cmaj7	Dense comp	backbeat shells	Sparse lead	1 target + rest
Bm7b5-E7-Am7-Am7	Sparse comp	root + shell	Dense lead	arpeggio + approach
Gmaj7-Em7-Am7-D7	Dense lead	motif sequence	Sparse comp	2 attacks / bar
Amaj7-F#m7-Bm7-E7	Sparse lead	guide tones	Dense comp	syncopated triads
AmMaj7-D7-E7-Am6	Dense comp	upper triads	Sparse lead	mode-color targets
C#m7-F#m7-G#7alt-C#m7	Sparse comp	shells	Dense lead	altered approach + target

First perform only the sparse version. Then only the dense version. Final pass switches roles after two bars while keeping the same harmonic targets and bar count.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module G - ear-led role-switch command deck

16 COMMANDS | 64 EVENTS

PLAYER MUST HEAR THE FIRST TARGET OF THE NEW ROLE BEFORE SWITCHING

1. Comp Cmaj7 -> lead on E

Sing target: _____

2. Lead over G7 -> comp Cmaj7

Sing target: _____

3. Comp Am7 -> lead on C

Sing target: _____

4. Lead over E7 -> comp Am

Sing target: _____

5. Comp Dm7 -> lead on F

Sing target: _____

6. Lead over D7 -> comp Gmaj7

Sing target: _____

7. Comp Bm7b5 -> lead on D

Sing target: _____

8. Lead over B7 -> comp Em7

Sing target: _____

9. Low comp -> high lead

Sing target: _____

10. High lead -> middle shells

Sing target: _____

11. Roots -> guide-tone line

Sing target: _____

12. Triads -> single-note motif

Sing target: _____

13. Lead sparse -> comp dense

Sing target: _____

14. Comp dense -> lead sparse

Sing target: _____

15. Visual cue -> switch role

Sing target: _____

16. One extra bar -> preserve current role

Sing target: _____

Partner reads one command during the current bar. Player sings the new-role target on the final beat, switches role on the next barline, and continues without a count restart.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module H - 16-bar integrated source form

FORM + TARGETS | 64 EVENTS

THE SAME FORM SUPPORTS COMPING, LEAD, TARGET PREDICTION, AND ROLE SWITCHING

Bar	Chord	Primary role	Pre-heard target	Cue / task
1	Cmaj7	comp	E	sing during count-in
2	Am7	comp	C	sing target on prior beat 4
3	Dm7	lead	F	sing target on prior beat 4
4	G7	lead	B	sing target on prior beat 4
5	Cmaj7	lead	E	sing target on prior beat 4
6	A7	lead	C#	sing target on prior beat 4
7	Dm7	comp	F	sing target on prior beat 4
8	G7	comp	B	sing target on prior beat 4
9	Cmaj7	comp	B	sing target on prior beat 4
10	E7	lead	G#	sing target on prior beat 4
11	Am7	lead	C	sing target on prior beat 4
12	D7	lead	F#	sing target on prior beat 4
13	Gmaj7	comp	B	sing target on prior beat 4
14	Am7	comp	C	sing target on prior beat 4
15	D7	lead	F#	sing target on prior beat 4

The role labels are fixed for the first pass. Later passes randomize selected handoffs while preserving the same chord sequence and target schedule.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Module H - 16-bar capstone: five-pass rehearsal ladder

5 PASSES | 64 EVENTS EACH

DO NOT ADD IMPROVISATION COMPLEXITY UNTIL THE PRE-HEARD TARGETS SURVIVE THE ROLE CHANGES

1. Targets only

Sing every beat-one target; play one note; rest for remainder of bar.

2. Accompaniment only

Use roots, shells, or triads. Sing upcoming lead targets even though no lead is played.

3. Printed role map

Follow the comp/lead roles from page 16 exactly. Keep beat 4 available before handoffs.

4. Randomized cues

Partner changes four role handoffs. Player simplifies immediately and preserves the form.

5. Free orchestration

Choose role, register, density, and articulation, but keep the chord and target schedule intact.

Record pass 5. On playback, mute the video or look away from the instrument and ask whether the harmonic destinations and role changes are still audible.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Level 78 capstone worksheet - prediction, handoff, and recovery

16 BARS | SCORE BEFORE REPEATING

RECORD ONE COMPLETE TAKE BEFORE CORRECTING INDIVIDUAL BARS

Bars	Targets heard first?	Role switch clean?	Form stable?	Best recovery	Score /
1-4					
5-8					
9-12					

Score one point each

Target sung before attack
First guitar attack correct
Bar count preserved
Chord function clear
Role change on time
Register / density contrast
Recovery without stop
Ending intentional

Failure hierarchy

1. Lost pulse / form
2. Missed role cue
3. Wrong chord / target
4. Search before attack
5. Texture mismatch
6. Ornament / articulation

Passing block = 7/8 or better. Complete performance = all four blocks pass without restarting. If a block fails, rehearse only the final bar before it and the first bar of the failed block, then repeat the complete take.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Spontaneous duet and ensemble-role laboratory

8 EXERCISES | REAL-TIME LISTENING

THE PLAYER MUST LEAVE MUSICAL SPACE FOR ANOTHER VOICE, EVEN WHEN PRACTICING ALONE

Exercise	Role schedule	Harmony / cue
1. Four-bar trade	2 bars comp / 2 bars lead	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7
2. One-bar trade	1 bar comp / 1 bar lead	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7
3. Question / shell answer	lead phrase / chord shell	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7
4. Shell / melodic answer	shell cue / 3-note response	Bm7b5-E7-Am7
5. Register handoff	low role / high role	Gmaj7-Em7-Am7-D7
6. Density handoff	sparse / dense	Amaj7-F#m7-Bm7-E7
7. Hidden cue	partner signals switch	any 4-bar form
8. Error rescue	partner inserts extra bar	preserve form by listening

Solo practice substitute: record the accompaniment role first, then answer it live. Next reverse the process by recording the lead and comping around its spaces.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 78

Practice progression, mastery gate, and Section X direction

ADVANCE WHEN THE EAR PREDICTS BEFORE THE HAND MOVES

LEVEL 78 IS PASSED BY PREDICTION AND RECOVERY, NOT BY SOLO DENSITY

Ten-phase progression

- [ ] 1. Major pre-heard targets
- [ ] 2. Minor pre-heard targets
- [ ] 3. Major guide lines
- [ ] 4. Minor guide lines
- [ ] 5. Phrase prediction
- [ ] 6. Motif continuation
- [ ] 7. Comp -> lead
- [ ] 8. Lead -> comp
- [ ] 9. Random role cues
- [ ] 10. 16-bar capstone

Error diagnosis

Target right after search -> sing earlier

Target wrong but chord right -> ear/function gap

Cue missed -> phrase ended too late

Form lost during lead -> reduce density

Comp re-entry late -> leave more silence

Role switch unclear -> change register/texture

Mastery gate

- [ ] Pre-hear and land all 24 major/minor targets with one decisive attack.
- [ ] Sing both guide-tone voices through six major and six minor cadences.
- [ ] Predict at least 10/12 phrase completions before seeing the answer.
- [ ] Continue all eight motifs while preserving the requested identity variable.

Next direction

Level 79 will synthesize Section X into complete-performance improvisation: long-form dynamic arcs, multiple key centers, rhythmic displacement, ear-led recovery, ensemble cues, and a multi-chorus performance designed to test the entire advanced integration layer.

The goal is a player who can hear, predict, support, answer, recover, and continue - without separating those actions into different practice worlds.